



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Clermont Christian School

School Website: <https://www.westcler.k12.oh.us/WCMS/home/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Clermont Christian School (Amelia, OH, 45102) appears to demonstrate limited alignment with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements and the accompanying keyword lexicon. Across Categories 1–5, public-facing materials from the school's site emphasize general, student-centered, and community-focused aspects rather than the explicit formation of character through transcendental, theological, liberal-arts curricula, or Socratic pedagogy. The strongest evidence of classical alignment is in Element 6 (Parents & Community), where the site highlights family involvement (e.g., Family Nights and family-friendly activities), echoing the classical emphasis on partnership with families. However, for Categories 1–5, explicit references to core classical elements (truth, goodness, beauty as transcendentals; a Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum; Great Books/Great Conversation; Socratic pedagogy; teacher-as-virtue-model; and formal parent-education/theology) are not evident in the public materials currently available in the crawl.

- Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL
- Category-by-category snapshot:
- Element 1: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

The assessment hinges on explicit textual evidence in the public materials. Where the site mentions family involvement (Element 6), it provides some alignment with classical priorities around parental partnership and formation in the home, but it does not consistently demonstrate the breadth of classical features across the other categories.

Key supporting sources include the school-crawl excerpts showing family-focused engagement (e.g., Family Nights and family-friendly activities) and the absence of explicit classical lexicon (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic seminars, Scholé) in the publicly accessible content. See citations to the school crawl material for Element 6 and to the absence of explicit classical cues in Categories 1–5.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- The school-crawl content emphasizes community and relationships but does not demonstrate explicit transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical practices, or sacred rites in the public materials available. The material emphasizes general school life and family engagement rather than explicit theological framing. See the public-facing presentation of Our Student Experience and related content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0
- Negative keywords present: 0
- The explicit classical lexicon (truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; reverence; etc.) is not evidenced in the crawl content. The absence yields an alignment with NOT CLASSICAL for this category.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, or liturgical community practices cited in public materials, the school does not meet the core criteria for Element 1 per the classical rubric. The absence of terms like truth/goodness/beauty as transcendentals, theology, or liturgical life in the public materials supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe student relationships and student-centered experiences, but do not clearly articulate formation toward virtue and wisdom as a telos, or the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. No explicit statements about formation over information or liberal paideia aims are evident in the crawl content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0
- Negative keywords present: 0
- The site does not explicitly reference the classical aims such as formation of character, contemplation (scholé), or the pursuit of transcendentals.
- Why this rating
- Lacking explicit articulation of formation toward virtue/wisdom and transcendentals, the category does not meet the classical standard. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl content centers on general school life, with no explicit mention of the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium), no Great Books access, no Great Conversation, and no clear interdisciplinary unity across history, philosophy, literature, and sciences as a canonical curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0
- Negative keywords present: 0
- Absence of Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or cross-disciplinary canonical curriculum references.
- Why this rating
- The lack of explicit classical curriculum elements places Element 3 in NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- There is no public indication of Socratic discussion, scholé-based pacing, memorization/chanting, or formation through imitation and practice in the crawl content. The material emphasizes relationships and student-centered experiences rather than classical pedagogical methods.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0
- Negative keywords present: 0
- No explicit presence of Socratic seminars, memory work, or chanting in the crawl evidence.
- Why this rating
- Absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals yields NOT CLASSICAL for Element 4.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl shows standard “Our Team,” “Board of Education” and related administrative content, but no explicit portrayal of teachers as virtuous models, mentors, or the living curriculum, nor an explicit “portrait of a teacher” in the classical sense.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: 0
- Negative keywords present: 0
- No explicit “teacher as model” or “living curriculum” language evidenced in the crawl.
- Why this rating
- Without clear evidence of faculty embodying classical virtues or a distinctive classical faculty culture, Element 5 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site highlights family engagement and opportunities for families to participate (e.g., Family Nights; family-friendly activities). This aligns with the classical emphasis on partnership with families and parental involvement in formation. The crawl content explicitly mentions Family Nights as a pathway for families to engage with the school.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families (explicit in the classical lexicon) and Formation of Affections (delight in truth, beauty, and goodness) are part of the classical keyword set. The school's content shows family involvement and engagement, which maps to these concepts in spirit even if not using the exact lexical phrases.
- Evidence: The public materials describe inviting families to Family Nights and emphasize family-friendly engagement, consistent with partnership with families and family formation concepts.
- Negative keywords present: 0
- The site does not appear to present values-neutral or relativistic framing in this area; instead it emphasizes family involvement.

- Why this rating
 - The presence of family involvement and explicit invitation to parents to engage (Family Nights) provides partial alignment with the Element 6 expectations. It's not enough to push Element 6 to CLASSICAL, but it yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for this category. The Positive keyword framework supports this interpretation, with clear mapping to the framework's Partnership with Families and related formation concepts.
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What Would Move the Needle

- Adopt and publicly articulate a clear classical curriculum structure (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; Great Conversation) and publicly reference these elements on the site, with explicit mention of how they shape curriculum and pedagogy (Categories 3 and 4).
 - Integrate and publicize explicit theological/themetical foundations (Element 1), including references to transcendental truth, goodness, and beauty; liturgical or liturgical-adjacent practices; and a formal statement of faith or Christian worldview that connects to other disciplines.
 - Elevate the faculty narrative (Element 5) by presenting teachers as models of virtue, a living curriculum, and a collaborative faculty culture; share quotes or mini-profiles illustrating virtue, mentorship, and collegiality.
 - Strengthen pedagogy (Element 4) by detailing the method mix: Socratic seminars in appropriate grade bands, memory/restful learning (Scholé), and guidance on imitation and practice with exemplars in literature, history, and mathematics.
 - Expand and document parent-education initiatives (Element 6) with formal parent learning programs (e.g., classical book studies, catechesis, or home-centered formation) to deepen the partnership with families and to anchor formation in the home as part of the classical project.
 - Increase explicit signaling around "great books" and "great conversation" in the curriculum pages, including sample reading lists, canon references, and how students engage with primary sources.
 - Provide a transparent mapping of how the school's mission aligns with the classical framework (truth, goodness, beauty as real; formation over information; integrated curriculum; restfulScholé pace; and the pedagogy of memory and dialogic inquiry).
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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